

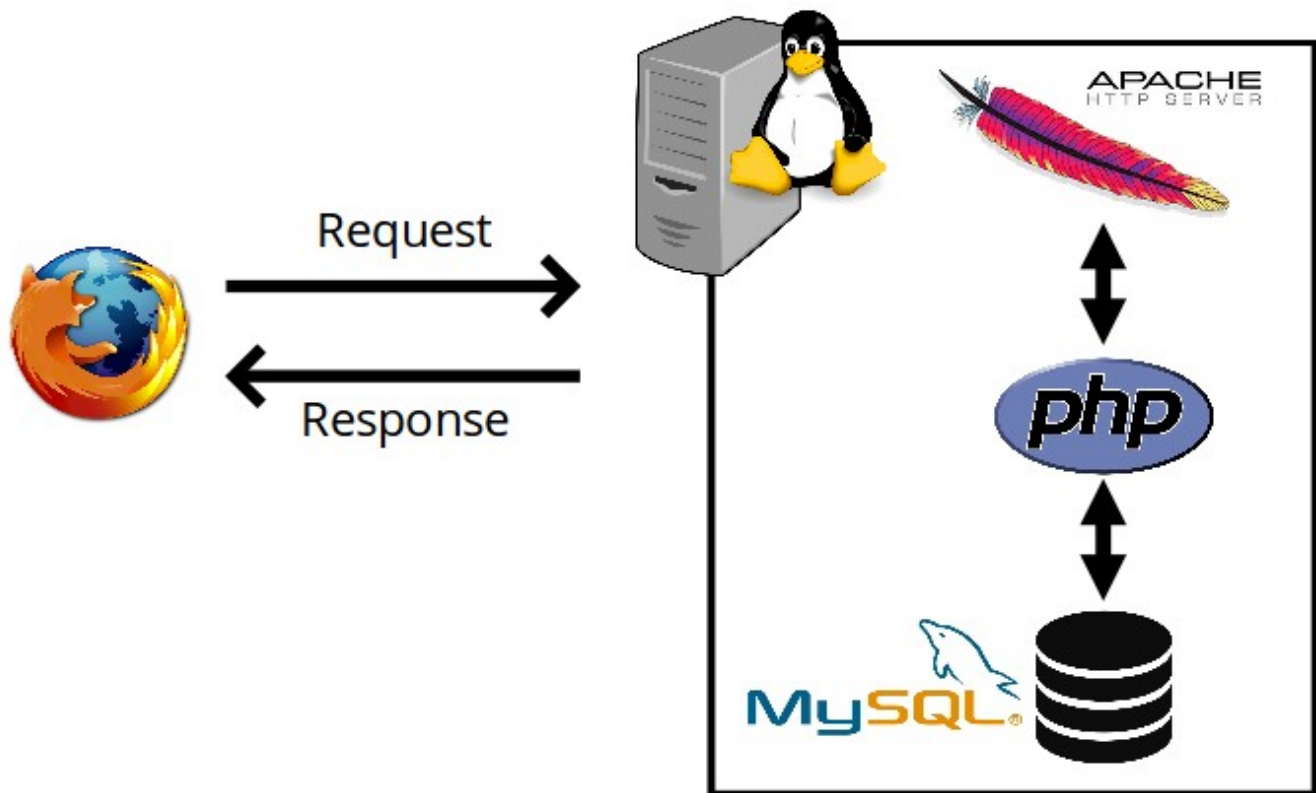
About the Wildfire Infrastructure

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Server-Side: The LAMP Stack

Linux	The operating system on which a developer usually runs his tools, including Apache, MySQL, and PHP.
Apache	The web server that listens to requests, runs PHP applications, and responds with HTML content. (<i>Production servers may run nginx instead of Apache.</i>)
MySQL	A database application that stores data in an organized way (<i>tables</i>). Storage and retrieval of the data are accomplished by writing SQL statements on the tables.
PHP	H ypertext P reprocessor. The scripting language by which Apache runs SQL statements and render the results as HTML content.

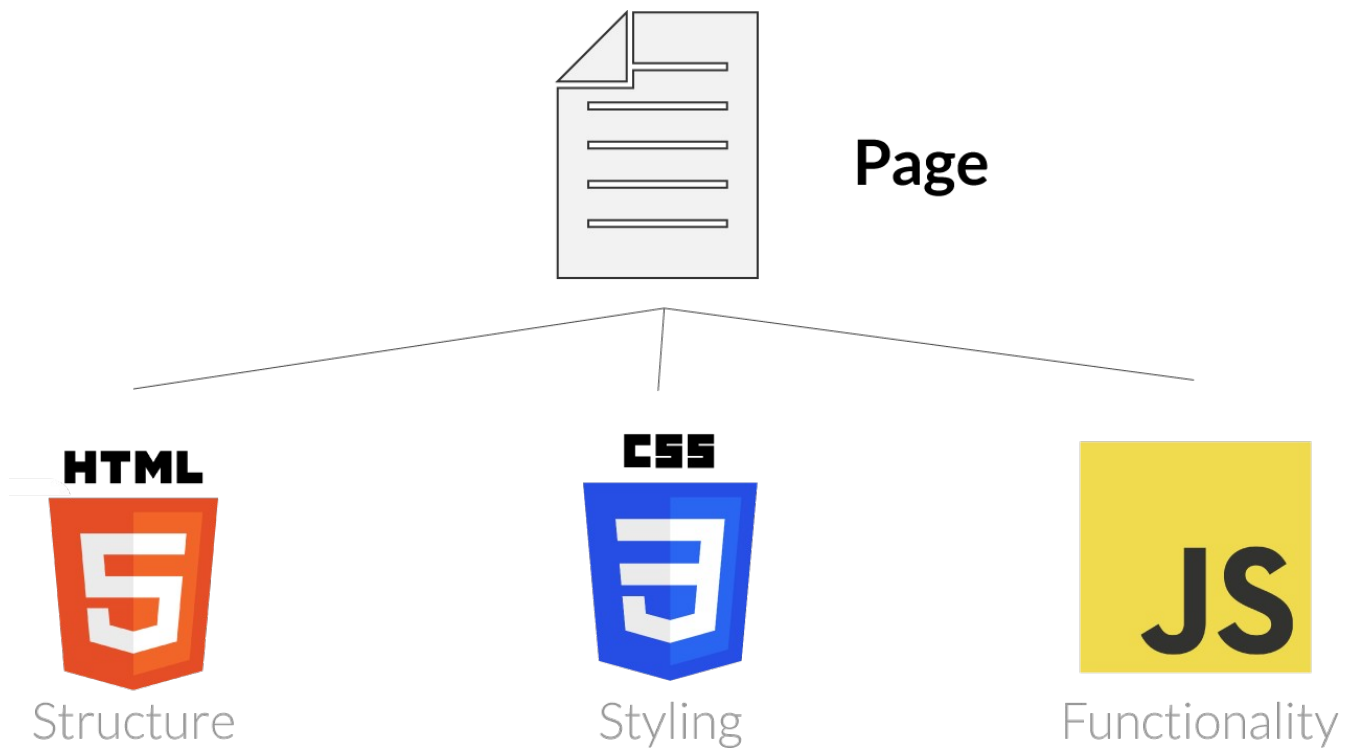


Relationship between LAMP stack and user's web browser

(image taken from <https://www.quora.com/What-is-the-meaning-of-LAMP-and-why-do-we-need-it-in-order-to-make-the-database-work>)

Client-Side

HTML	HyperText Markup Language. The standard markup language for documents designed to be displayed in a web browser.
CSS	Cascading Style Sheets. A language used for describing the presentation of a document written in HTML.
JS	JavaScript. A programming language that adds interactive behavior to HTML content.



How a web browser renders content returned from the LAMP stack

(image taken from <https://blog.codeanalogies.com/2018/05/09/the-relationship-between-html-css-and-javascript-explained/>)

Drupal

Drupal is a free and open-source web content management system (CMS) written in PHP and distributed under the GNU General Public License. Drupal provides an open-source back-end framework for at least 14% of the top 10,000 websites worldwide – ranging from personal blogs to corporate, political, and government sites. Systems also use Drupal for knowledge management and for business collaboration.



As of March 2021, the Drupal community comprised more than 1.39 million members, including 121,000 users actively contributing, resulting in more than 46,800 free modules that extend and customize Drupal functionality, over 2,900 free themes that change the look and feel of Drupal, and at least 1,300 free distributions (or **distributions**) that allow users to quickly and easily set up a complex, use-specific Drupal in fewer steps.

The standard release of Drupal, known as **Drupal core**, contains basic features common to content-management systems. These include user account registration and maintenance, menu management, RSS feeds, taxonomy, page layout customization, and system administration. The Drupal core installation can serve as a simple website, a single- or multi-user blog, an Internet forum, or a community website providing for user-generated content.

* Taken from Drupal Wikipedia entry (<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Drupal>).

Routes, Controllers and Responses: The Basic Life Cycle of a Drupal 8 Request

Whether viewing a node on the front-end, consuming a JSON end point, or using the admin interface, every request in Drupal 8 follows the same workflow: **routing**, a **controller**, and a **response**.

[This video](#) uncovers the basic life cycle of a Drupal 8 request, by creating a custom page using routes, a controller and a response. It then examines how Drupal uses this *exact* same process to fuel node pages, the admin interface, and everything else. To create custom pages or open up the hood and really understand Drupal 8, this is your first step.

Slides accompanying this video can be found [here](#).

Drupal Distributions

Distributions are full copies of Drupal that include Drupal Core, along with additional software such as themes, modules, libraries, and installation profiles. There are two main types of Drupal distributions:

- **Full-featured distributions:** Complete solutions for specialized use cases.
- **Other distributions:** Quick-start tools, starting points for developers and site builders.

Instructions for writing Drupal distribution profiles can be found [here](#).

* Taken from Drupal Wikipedia entry (<https://www.drupal.org/docs/drupal-distributions#:~:text=Distributions%20are%20full%20copies%20of,solutions%20for%20specialized%20use%20cases.>).

The **Wildfire** distribution files can be found on [Bitbucket](#).

Wildfire



*The **Wildfire** platform is a Drupal distribution that lets you create and life-cycle manage a website tailored to your needs and objectives. It complements your social media presence. Using theme-based templates and drag-and-drop functionality, non-technical users can build multilingual websites, seamlessly supporting access via PCs and mobile devices.”*



As a Drupal distribution, Wildfire does many things for us – like user management, creating and displaying content, caching – and allows us to create modules that can extend, alter, or add new functionality that is relevant for what our clients need. Some examples of our added functionality are simple ways to include Scripture reading apps, Audio Bibles, and *JESUS* movies. When it comes to altering the behavior, we created our own page builder to make the interface simpler for our target audience, who might not always be tech-savvy and would struggle if it's too complicated.

Because Drupal is open-source, we can use, modify, and extend the code to meet our needs, and make use of the work done by many others in the Drupal community. In return, wherever we can, we try to share relevant code back to the community for other Drupal developers to use if they wish.

Why Use Wildfire Instead of Other CMSs Like Joomla or WordPress?

1. ***The IPS team tries to support communities when they create their own web space.*** While we currently use our configuration of Drupal to help these communities, in the future it might be possible to use something else.
2. ***Another important point is legacy.*** We've used Drupal for many years and developed many modules on top of it. These modules allow us to do many things that are specific to our domain, and we would have to re-purpose them to fit Joomla or WordPress. When the IPS team first started its mission, Drupal was probably the best solution in the field. While Drupal is still one of the best players, there are very good alternative solutions.
3. ***We already have a configuration of our own modules and other people's modules that we deliver to the people and that works well as a set.***
4. ***Our developers are familiar with the Drupal way of things.*** Working with something else would require us to learn a lot of new things. This is not necessarily bad. Developers should always look beyond their own tech bubbles and consider other available options.
5. ***We have hundreds of websites running on our servers that we not only started, but we also support, including the creation of updates and new functionality.*** If we changed to WordPress or Joomla, we would need to do something with the old websites:
 - *Leave them on Drupal and let them slowly die.* If we didn't actively support the system, it would become outdated within months.
 - *Migrate the sites to a different CMS.* This is a massive step and requires several fully dedicated programmers. We are now migrating our sites to a new version of Drupal because support for the older versions will stop soon. Just going from Drupal to Drupal is a challenging and resource-intensive task; migrating to a different CMS would be a much bigger challenge.